

User Persona

User Persona: Sarah

Founder & Talent Architect, 50-person Tech Co.



Goals & Motivations

- ★ Find "A-Players" & Perfect Fits ↑
- 🕒 Reduce Time-to-Hire
- 🛡️ Prevent Strategic Burnout ↑

Pain Points & Behaviors

- 📁 High Cost of Bad Hires \$18k!! 📱
- 💰 FOMO & Burnout

Ideal Solution & Preferences

- 🔍 AI-Powered Smart ATS 🔍
- 📄 Fast, Seamless Oop 5% Candidates

Key Details

- Age: 29-42
- Role: Founder/Head of Talent
- Company: Tech/SAAS Startup
- Team Size: 50 employees
- Location: Hybrid/Remote

"I need to stop sifting and start building. My team waiting."

Link -

https://www.canva.com/design/DAHA7xFWMzw/H40VUr2Cj05K6UVJVNX4GA/edit?utm_content=DAHA7xFWMzw&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=sharebutton

Problem Statement

"Sarah, a founder at a 50-person tech company, needs a way to **identify the top 5% of candidates instantly** without manually opening hundreds of PDFs. Currently, her hiring process is so slow and high-friction that **top-tier talent is ghosting her** for other offers,

forcing her to choose between settling for a 'bad fit' or leaving her team chronically understaffed and burnt out."

Market Research

Small to mid-sized companies (SMEs) face significant hiring inefficiencies, particularly in screening high volumes of resumes without dedicated HR teams. Key pain points include talent shortages and prolonged processes that lead to lost productivity and higher turnover.[press.roberthalf+3](#)

Key Pain Points

- **Resume Screening Overload:** SMEs receive hundreds of applications but spend excessive time manually reviewing them, often 6-8 seconds per resume, leading to errors and bias.[avenueeco+1](#)
- **Talent Shortages and Skills Gaps:** Over 40% struggle to find candidates with required skills, exacerbated by competition from larger firms.[linkedin+1](#)
- **Salary Competition Pressures:** Nearly half cite meeting candidate salary expectations as a top challenge, straining limited budgets.[skillfuel+1](#)
- **Prolonged Hiring Cycles:** Slow processes cause 40% to lose top candidates to competitors, resulting in team burnout and 50% higher turnover rates.[cypresshcm+1](#)
- **Lack of HR Expertise:** Founders or managers handle hiring without specialized skills, leading to poor job descriptions and inconsistent interviews.[linkedin](#)
- **Culture and Fit Mismatches:** More than 40% find it hard to identify candidates aligning with company culture, increasing turnover risks.[press.roberthalf](#)
- **High Costs and Turnover:** SMEs spend \$8K-\$18K annually per hire, with 60% new hires leaving in the first month, creating vicious cycles.[webcotalent](#)

Most Impacted Parties

- **SMEs and Startups:** 89% are chronically understaffed, with owners diverting time from growth; they lack budgets and teams compared to enterprises.[jazzhr+1](#)
- **Existing Employees:** Bear heavier workloads during vacancies, leading to burnout, low morale, and turnover.[aihr+1](#)
- **Business Growth:** Stalled projects and operational strain delay expansion, costing up to 200% of salary in poor hires.[aihr](#)

Existing Solutions

- **AI-Powered ATS Tools:** Platforms like CVViZ, Skima AI, and Recooty automate screening, ranking candidates by skills and fit in seconds.[cvviz+2](#)
- **Resume Screening Software:** Tools such as ResumeRank and Workable parse resumes, reduce bias, and integrate with workflows for SMEs.[resumerank+1](#)
- **Automation Features:** AI matching (e.g., HireVue, Jobscan) handles high volumes, shortlisting top fits and rediscovering past applicants.[resumescreening+1](#)

Summary:

Small to mid-sized companies (SMEs) face major hiring pain points like **overwhelming resume screening volumes without dedicated HR**, talent shortages amid fierce competition, **prolonged hiring cycles leading to lost candidates**, and **high costs from turnover and poor fits**. These issues drain time from founders and managers, inflate expenses up to \$18K per bad hire, and stall business growth. **SMEs and startups are most impacted as chronically understaffed entities** lacking resources, alongside overburdened employees suffering burnout.[avenueeco+5](#)